Vasishthas. It was neither the philologist nor the scholar that I saw, but a soul that is every day realizing its oneness with the universe.' (Swami Nikhilananda, *Vivekananda: A Biography*, 1953.)

24 Swami Giri's *Myth of the Aryan invasion* is an online publication, not to be confused with *The Myth of the Aryan Invasion of India* written by another US convert to Hinduism, the prolific author David Frawley whose books include *In Search of the Cradle of Civilisation* (1995) which also rejects the Aryan Invasion Theory.

25 Mahesh Sharma, quoted in an interview published in the *Indian Express* on 11 September 2015.

26 I happen to disagree with quite a few of the judgements that Professor Thapar has made in the course of what now amounts to a huge body of published work extending over half a century, particularly with regard to Muslim iconoclasm, but I fully acknowledge that those conclusions were arrived at on the basis of thorough research and not ideology, which is what differentiates her and her colleagues from their opponents.

27 Romila Thapar, *The Past and Prejudice*, 1975, originally broadcast on All-India Radio as three lectures in January 1972.

28 Romila Thapar, 'Hindutva and history: why do Hindutva ideologues keep flogging a dead horse?', *Frontline*, Vol. 17, Issue 20, 30 Sep–13 Oct 2000. More recently still, the distinguished economist and Nobel Laureate Dr Amartya Sen has written at length about the emergence of the Hindutva phenomenon and the dangers posed by its rewriting of Indian history in *The Argumentative Indian: Writings on Indian Culture, History and Identity*, published in 2005.

29 Wendy Doniger, *The Hindus: An Alternative History*, 2009. Quoted in her Introduction, p.17.

30 James W. Laine, *Shivaji: Hindu King in Islamic India*, 2003.